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★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 47368.63 ▲ 381.53 0.81% NASDAQ 23527.17 ▲ 2.3% STOXX 600 572.82 ▲ 1.4% 10-YR. TREAS. ▼ 5/32, yield 4.109% OIL \$60.13 ▲ \$0.38 GOLD \$4,111.80 ▲ \$112.40 EURO \$1.1559 YEN 154.14

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Warren Buffett wrote** that he will keep a significant amount of Berkshire Hathaway's Class A stock until shareholders grow comfortable with his successor as CEO, Greg Abel. **A1**
- ◆ **A relief rally lifted** major U.S. stock indexes, with the S&P 500 rising 1.5% and the Nasdaq and Dow gaining 2.3% and 0.8%, respectively. **B1**
- ◆ **Apollo agreed to** acquire a majority stake in Spanish football club Atlético de Madrid, extending investors' interests in European soccer. **B1**
- ◆ **Paramount reported** growth from its streaming division in its first quarterly earnings report since the company's merger with David Ellison's Skydance Media. **B3**
- ◆ **CoreWeave, one of** the top providers of cloud-computing services for AI firms, saw revenue more than double in the third quarter. **B4**
- ◆ **Coinbase launched** a platform to allow individual investors to purchase digital tokens before they are listed on its exchange. **B4**
- ◆ **Diageo appointed** Dave Lewis as its chief executive, tapping a consumer-industry veteran to revitalize the spirits company as it contends with faltering demand in the U.S. and China. **B2**
- ◆ **KKR struck a deal** to sell Novaria Group, a supplier to the aerospace and defense sector, to buyout firm Arcline for \$2.2 billion in cash. **B2**
- ◆ **Tyson Foods expects** high beef prices to persist into next year as the U.S. cattle shortage continues to squeeze the meatpacking industry's profits. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **The Senate passed** a spending package to end the government shutdown, and the measure now goes to the House for a final vote. The decision by eight members of the Democratic caucus to side with Republicans drew condemnation from other party members. **A1**
- ◆ **Progressive voters are** focusing their fury on Senate Minority Leader Chuck Schumer in the aftermath of what they see as a collapse by Senate Democrats. **A4**
- ◆ **Chief Justice John Roberts** enters his third decade leading the Supreme Court with the defining challenge of how far to let Trump's presidency rewrite the bounds of executive power. **A1**
- ◆ **The Supreme Court rejected** a long-shot bid to overturn the landmark 2015 decision that gave same-sex couples the constitutional right to marry. **A2**
- ◆ **Trump pardoned top** allies including Rudy Giuliani in connection with efforts to overturn the results of the 2020 presidential election. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump threatened** to file a \$1 billion lawsuit against the BBC over the way the U.K. state broadcaster edited one of his speeches in a documentary. **A9**
- ◆ **A car exploded in** a densely populated New Delhi neighborhood near the Red Fort monument, killing at least eight people. **A8**
- ◆ **The FDA said** manufacturers should remove black-box warnings on hormone-replacement-therapy drugs, citing clinical trials showing no association with increased breast-cancer risk. **A3**

CONTENTS		Markets.....	B10
Arts in Review....	A13	Opinion.....	A15-17
Business & Finance	B2-6	Personal Journal	A11-12
Business News....	B3	Sports.....	A14
Crossword.....	A13	Technology.....	B4
Heard on Street....	B11	U.S. News.....	A2-6
Market Data.....	B8	World News....	A8-10



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Syrian Leader Warms to Trump, U.S. Partnership



REALIGNMENT: Syrian President Ahmed al-Sharaa, once designated by Washington as a terrorist, waves after meeting President Trump at the White House on Monday. U.S. officials said Syria is joining the effort against Islamic State. **A8**

Shareholders Drive Economy, But Everyone Else Is Wary

Stock market gains have given investors license to spend, but others sit out spree

By RACHEL LOUISE ENSIGN AND RACHEL WOLFE

A few months ago, with the market surging, Rick Wichmann watched his investment portfolio balloon in value. The 67-year-old retired consultant sold his Toyota and leased a new Tesla. After one of the air-conditioning units in his Brookline, Mass., home broke, he decided to replace the

whole property's HVAC system this fall at a cost of \$72,000.

When stocks fell last week, he spoke to his financial adviser, who added some options to protect against declines. But Wichmann is staying in the market and doesn't plan to cut back on spending.

"I'm fairly bullish about the economy," Wichmann said.

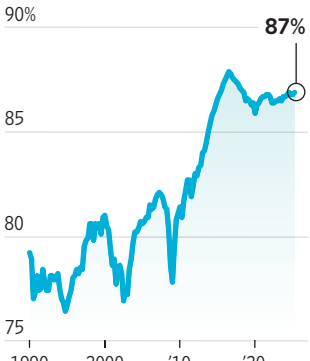
Many Americans who own stocks are feeling good about their finances, with a market that's continually shrugged off economic concerns and pushed major indexes to record highs. They have seen stocks dive through the dot-com bust, financial crisis and

onset of the pandemic—only to recover and keep going up. Even after a big selloff following President Trump's tariff announcements in April, and a smaller dip last week, the S&P 500 is up more than 16% so far this year. Gains in 30 top artificial intelligence-related stocks alone have added \$5 trillion to household wealth across the country in the past year, according to an October JPMorgan Chase report.

Investors' rosy feelings about having a lot more

◆ **Stocks soar on hopes for** shutdown resolution..... **B1**

Percentage of stocks and mutual funds held by the top 20% of earners



Source: Federal Reserve

Roberts Navigates Many Perils In Ruling On Tariffs

By JESS BRAVIN

WASHINGTON—Chief Justice John Roberts faces a defining challenge as he enters his third decade leading the Supreme Court: how far to let Donald Trump's presidency rewrite the bounds of executive power.

Over Trump's first year back in office, the court has given the president wide latitude to implement his policies, through some two dozen emergency orders that paused the effect of lower-court rulings against the administration. But it hadn't fully reviewed any of Trump's actions until last Wednesday's hearing on Trump's global tariffs, where the dynamics shifted: Most justices suggested the president acted beyond his legal authority.

If those sentiments find their way into a ruling, it would be the court's first real blow to Trump in more than five years. Now it is up to Roberts to cobble together a decision on a policy that Trump has portrayed as essential to the nation.

In addition to pressure from the president, the chief justice is navigating colleagues who have clashing visions of what the court should be. And he is under scrutiny from judges and court watchers who still aren't sure what

◆ **Court won't reconsider** same-sex marriage..... **A2**

INSIDE



JASON GAY

Jonathan Taylor has been the NFL's most dominant player. Why can't he be MVP? **A14**

BUSINESS & FINANCE

The credit-card rule that powers premium rewards just got broken. **B1**

Buffett to Keep Class A Shares While His Successor Settles In

By KRYSTAL HUR

Berkshire Hathaway's Warren Buffett wrote that he will keep a "significant amount" of the company's Class A stock until his fellow shareholders grow comfortable with his successor as chief executive, Greg Abel.

"That level of confidence shouldn't take long," Buffett wrote on Monday in a letter to shareholders and his three children. "My children are already 100% behind Greg as are the Berkshire directors."

Buffett, 95 years old, surprised the investing world at Berkshire's annual shareholder

meeting in May when he said Abel would take over as chief executive officer at year's end. Berkshire has said Buffett would remain chairman.

The company's shares have since slumped, with some attributing the declines to a shrinking "Buffett premium"—the higher price investors are willing to pay to own Berkshire's stock, thanks to the chairman's presence.

In Monday's letter, Buffett reiterated his faith in Abel.

"He is a great manager, a tireless worker and an honest communicator," he wrote. "Wish him an extended tenure." The succession plan will

also bring changes to long-standing traditions for Berkshire followers. Abel will take over writing the annual letter to shareholders, Buffett's assistant confirmed recently to The Wall Street Journal. And starting next year, Abel will lead Berkshire's annual meetings while Buffett sits with the company's other directors.

For decades, Buffett's shareholder letters have resonated far beyond Berkshire's investors, reaching a broader group of admirers eager to read his latest thoughts on a range of business and eco-

Please turn to page A4

Basta Pasta, America: No More Italian Noodles

By MARGHERITA STANCATI AND GAVIN BADE

CAMPOBASSO, Italy—Your favorite Italian-origin fusilli and macaroni are poised to disappear from supermarkets. Saying duties totaling 107% on their brands will make doing business in the U.S. too costly, Italy's biggest pasta exporters are preparing to pull out of U.S. stores as soon as January.

"It's an incredibly important market for us," said Giuseppe Ferro, La Molisana's chief executive, whose family-run pasta factory sits on the edge of the southern Italian town of Campobasso. "But no one has those kinds of margins."

The U.S. Commerce Department has announced a 92% antidumping duty on pasta made in Italy by La Molisana

and 12 other companies, on top of the Trump administration's 15% tariff on imports from the European Union.

The Commerce Department acted after a long-running probe into pricing practices. The severity of the decision has stunned one of Italy's most iconic industries and escalated into a diplomatic dispute.

"It would be a real shame to have the market snatched from us for no real reason," said Ferro. La Molisana and the other companies are asking the Commerce Department to revise its assessment.

For Ferro, the fight is personal. He bought La Molisana, bankrupt at the time, in 2011 and turned it into one of Italy's leading *pastifici*, or pasta factories, with annual revenue of

Please turn to page A6

To Grow a 3,000-Pound Pumpkin, Start With a \$1,000 Seed

* * *

Growers spend hours tracing lineage. Even so, 'it's a roll of the dice.'

By ROSHAN FERNANDEZ

Andy Corbin runs an ancestry website—for gigantic pumpkins.

The IT worker started growing pumpkins 15 years ago. To help figure out which seeds to use, he built a database that now traces the family trees of thousands of gargantuan gourds back generations.

His pumpkin genetics tool is considered a necessity among growers of the world's heaviest fruit. Because before they compete at weigh-offs, these hobbyists vie

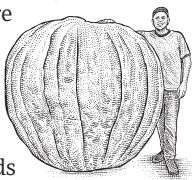
at auction for seeds with lineages of largeness.

"It's like breeding racehorses," said Ron Wallace, the first grower to break one ton in 2012.

The race to grow ever-larger gourds has unleashed a blitz of one-upsmanship at contests around the globe. The world record for heaviest pumpkin has been broken 21 times since 1993, including a record 2,819-pounder this year.

The prize for winning a weigh-off is typically a couple thousand dollars, but the horticultural bragging rights are

Please turn to page A12



Pulp fiction?